

SFPA Spring 2026 City Championship

Title Odds — Tournament Projection

Latest update: Jun 24, 2026, 9:39 PM · 60,000-run double-elimination simulation

Rawhides are the favorite to win the City Championship at **41%**, ahead of a tight chase between **Pilsner** (16%) and **El Farolito** (16%). Together the top three hold about 72% of all title equity; below them the field falls off sharply.

Team	Seed	Title %	Reach Final	Reach Semis
Happy Lounge Rawhides	1	40.9%	56%	61%
Pilsner InnDecisives	6	15.8%	34%	52%
El Farolito Shooters	2	15.6%	34%	61%
Hall Monitors	4	11.2%	26%	60%
Bus Stop Flyers	3	6.2%	17%	36%
Marcelo's Hall Stars	8	6.1%	15%	27%
Pocket Full of Fizz	7	1.5%	6%	29%
Happy HALLers	5	1.3%	5%	28%
Gino & Carlo	9	0.4%	2%	8%
Temple Holy Smokes	14	0.3%	1%	7%
Route 101 Dalmatians	12	0.2%	1%	7%
Friends Crooked Cues	11	0.1%	1%	5%
Lucky Horseshoe Glue Factory	10	0.1%	1%	6%
Bus Slop	15	0.1%	0%	5%
Karl's Freakin' Beacon	13	0.1%	0%	5%
Lower Haight Misfits	16	0.1%	0%	4%

The Storylines

Pilsner: 15-0 in the playoffs against everyone but Rawhides

The most remarkable number in this field belongs to a 6-seed. Over the last four City Championships, **Pilsner InnDecisives have gone 17-7 in playoff matches**, and every one of their losses came against a single team: the Happy Lounge Rawhides. Against the other fifteen playoff opponents they've faced, Pilsner is a perfect **15-0**, reaching the final four years running. That is why a sixth seed is the model's #2 title pick at 16% — the regular season undersells them.

The Burgess effect: why Pilsner slipped to the 6-seed

So why isn't Pilsner seeded higher? Their best player, **Evan Burgess (576 Fargo)**, **didn't play until Week 7**, missing the first half of the season. Pilsner won 57% of their games without him and 61% with him — enough of an early dip to drop them several seed lines, landing them sixth. He's back now and the lineup is whole, but the seeding is locked, and that one fact ripples through the entire bracket.

One half of the bracket is a war; the other is a stroll

The 6-seed lands Pilsner in the bottom half, alongside El Farolito (2) and Bus Stop (3) — three of the four strongest non-Rawhides teams stacked together, forced to eliminate each other just to reach the final. Rawhides' top half is far softer. The survival numbers say it plainly: **Rawhides reach the final 56%** of the time, while **El Farolito and Pilsner sit near 34%** — not because they're weak, but because their path is brutal.

Rawhides: so good on paper it barely matters that they've cooled off

By season form, Rawhides actually graded out slightly negative (-10) — they won a touch less than even their own loaded lineup predicted. Yet they're still the runaway #1 at 41%, because their Fargo (609) and Team Elo (1702) tower over the field by enough that a small slump doesn't move them. But favorite isn't lock: these are races to 9, and Pilsner has taken them to the brink repeatedly — Rawhides lead their nine playoff meetings 7-2, but two went Pilsner's way. An undefeated run is rare, and there are more strong teams in the field than ever.

El Farolito: the team playing above its paper

El Farolito posted the best season form in the field (+28) — consistently winning more than their roster's raw Fargo predicted, the signature of a team peaking at the right time. The model rewards it, lifting them into a co-#2 tie at 16%. The catch is the draw: stuck in the loaded bottom half, even a hot team faces Pilsner and Bus Stop before any shot at Rawhides.

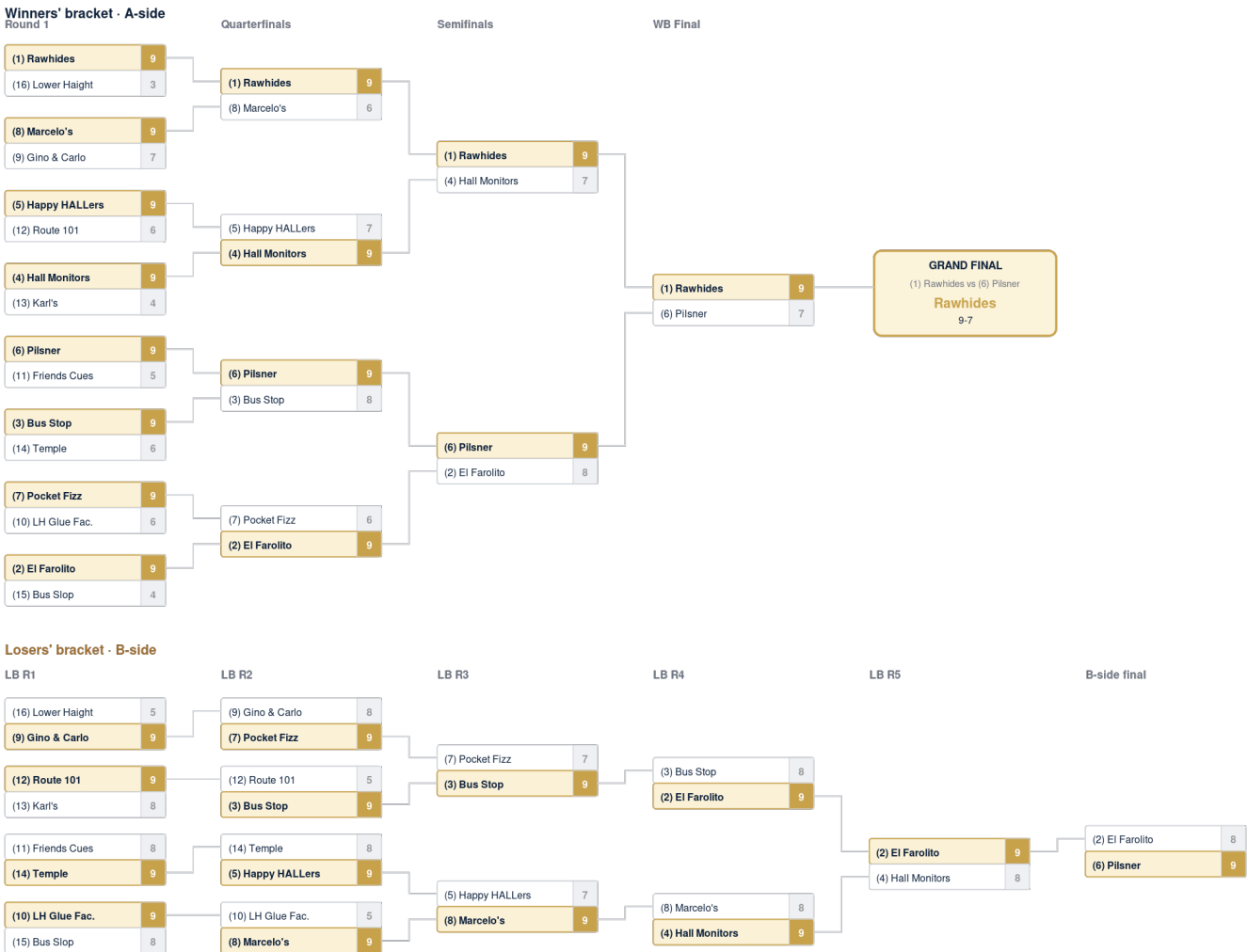
Team Elo — Overall Strength

Each team's strength rating: the Fargo of their best playoff lineup, adjusted for season form, plus a data-tested pedigree where earned. Higher = stronger. This is what drives the title odds.

Rank	Team	Team Elo	Top-4 Fargo	Title %
1	Happy Lounge Rawhides	1702	609.5	40.9%
2	Pilsner InnDecisives	1632	539.0	15.8%
3	Hall Monitors	1620	567.0	11.2%
4	El Farolito Shooters	1605	548.0	15.6%
5	Marcelo's Hall Stars	1598	553.8	6.1%
6	Bus Stop Flyers	1594	550.5	6.2%
7	Pocket Full of Fizz	1526	515.0	1.5%
8	Happy HALLers	1509	503.8	1.3%
9	Temple Holy Smokes	1508	513.2	0.3%
10	Gino & Carlo	1502	505.2	0.4%
11	Friends Crooked Cues	1454	478.0	0.1%
12	Route 101 Dalmatians	1412	455.8	0.2%
13	Lucky Horseshoe Glue Factory	1401	453.8	0.1%
14	Bus Slop	1378	443.2	0.1%
15	Karl's Freakin' Beacon	1363	431.8	0.1%
16	Lower Haight Misfits	1317	409.8	0.1%

Projected Bracket

Single most-likely path through the 16-team double elimination. Lose on the A-side (winners') and you drop to the B-side (losers"); a second loss ends your run. The B-side survivor must beat the A-side finalist twice. **Grand Final:** (1) Rawhides vs (6) Pilsner — champion **Rawhides** (9-7).



How the Model Works

- 1. Strength from the players who actually play.** Each team is rated by the Fargo ratings of its best four players. Season form is judged on who actually played each match, so a team isn't penalized for resting a star.
- 2. Race to 9, with real upset variance.** Playoff matches are a race to 9 games; the rating gap sets each game's odds, capped so even big favorites drop games. At 8-8 a single deciding game is played.
- 3. 60,000 simulated tournaments.** The full double-elimination bracket is played 60,000 times; every number here comes from that one simulation.
- 4. A data-tested pedigree for Pilsner.** Pilsner InnDecisives carries a measured playoff bump (+30 Fargo): over four seasons their playoff record is 4-season playoff record 17-7 (71%), 15-0 vs all non-Rawhides opponents; significant vs 50% null ($p=0.032$) No other team earned an adjustment.

Appendix — Season Form

A supporting metric, not a strength rating: did a team beat or miss its own roster's Fargo expectation this season, match by match? A strong team can show negative form if it underplayed its talent.

Team	Season Form	vs roster
El Farolito Shooters	+28.0	overachieved
Happy HALLers	+17.2	overachieved
Route 101 Dalmatians	+14.4	overachieved
Karl's Freakin' Beacon	+13.9	overachieved
Friends Crooked Cues	+11.6	overachieved
Lower Haight Misfits	+10.8	overachieved
Pocket Full of Fizz	+8.1	overachieved
Pilsner InnDecisives	+4.9	~ as expected
Lucky Horseshoe Glue Factory	+4.0	~ as expected
Bus Stop Flyers	+3.5	~ as expected
Gino & Carlo	+2.4	~ as expected
Bus Slop	+1.6	~ as expected
Marcelo's Hall Stars	+0.1	~ as expected
Hall Monitors	-7.3	underachieved
Happy Lounge Rawhides	-10.4	underachieved
Temple Holy Smokes	-13.5	underachieved